

THE BLACK PANTHER

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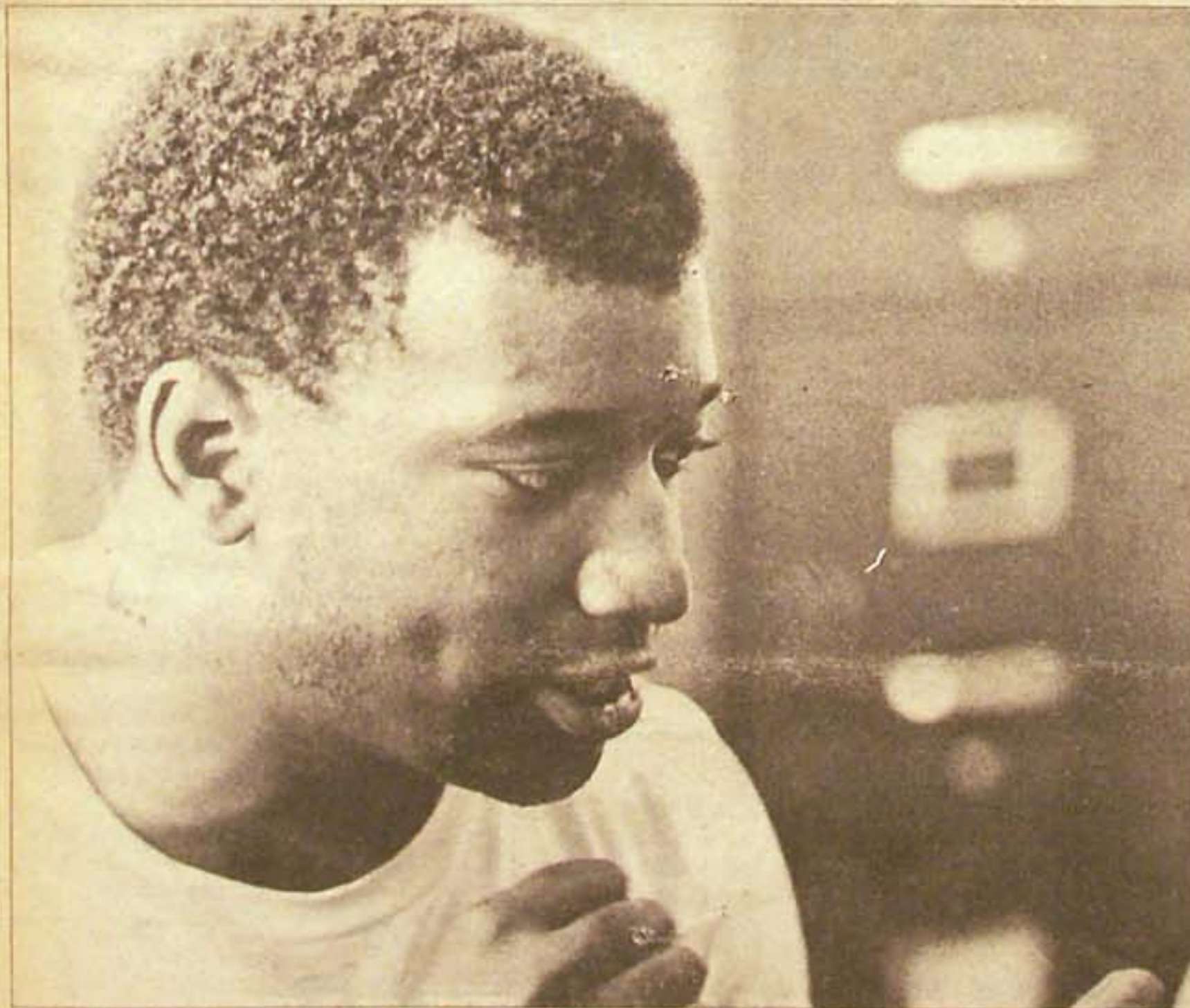
SATURDAY, APRIL 23, 1977

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Hanrahan Motion Accepted, Outrage Mounts

JUDGE DROPS ALL F.B.I. CONSPIRACY CHARGES IN FRED HAMPTON MURDER CASE



(Chicago, Ill.) - In one of the more amazing, unprecedented rulings in federal court history, Judge Samuel Perry last week dismissed charges against the FBI, former Cook County State's Attorney Edward Hanrahan and eight of the 15 police officers who were involved in the raid which led to the December 4 murders of Black Panther Party leaders Fred Hampton and Mark Clark in 1969.

After 16 months of documentation and testimony put on by the plaintiffs, who are the families of Fred Hampton and Mark Clark and the seven survivors of the raid, Perry, 80, a native of Alabama, not only dismissed the case on most of the defendants but ordered the plaintiffs to pay court costs estimated by some to be as high as half a million dollars.

Perry's new trial order, in effect, dismissed the plaintiffs' basic contention in the case; that the FBI conspired with Hanrahan to assassinate Hampton, the popular young leader of the Illinois Chapter of the Black Panther Party. By leaving in the case only those seven police officers who admittedly fired their guns, Perry has ruled that the murders of Fred Hampton, 21, and Mark Clark, 22, were, at most, a case of police brutality.

In arguing the defendants' motion to dismiss their charges, attorneys for the plaintiffs, Jeffery Haas and Flint Taylor, reminded the court of the hundreds of FBI documents that were entered into evidence, proving the (Counterintelligence Program) operation initiated by the federal agency against the Black Panther Party. The documents openly admit

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The vicious murder of Illinois BPP leader FRED HAMPTON has yet to be vindicated.

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